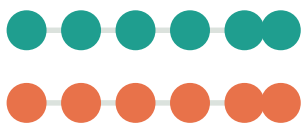


Is this triploid oyster really $3n$?

Think of chromosomes as **strings of colored beads**. A normal oyster has 2 strings; a triploid has 3.

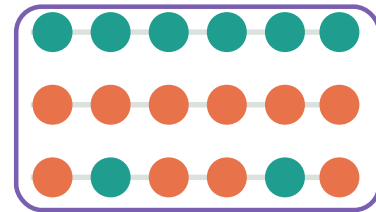
Normal oyster • $2n$

2 strings (1 mom + 1 dad)



Triploid oyster • $3n$

3 strings



● Parent A genes

● Parent B genes

● Triploid (3 strings)

Two questions this tool answers

Question 1

Is it really 3 strings?

Check whether it is 2 strings ($2n$) or 3 ($3n$).

Question 2

Which parents, how much?

Count how many of the 3 strings come from A vs B.

The whole flow

Read DNA pieces → stick them on a map → answer the two questions.

1

Read DNA

Sequence lots of short DNA pieces (reads).

2

Stick on a map

Align pieces to a reference genome (mapping).

3

Q1 • Triploidy check

Look at the mix ratio of two letters at one spot (nQuire).

4

Q2 • Count parents

Use parent-only markers (diagnostic SNPs) to count A.

5

Cross-check with many methods

See whether independent evidence agrees.

6

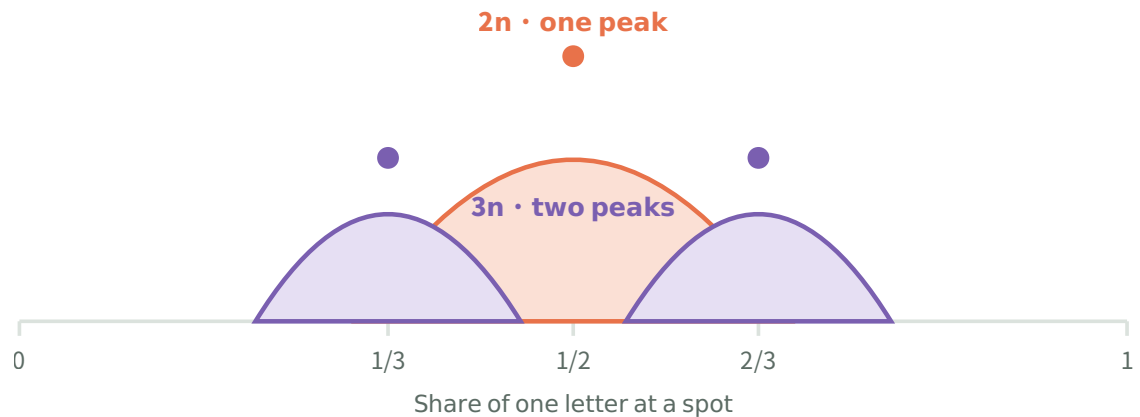
Integrated call

Combine evidence — conflicts are shown, not hidden.

QUESTION 1 • KEY IDEA

Look at the **mix ratio** of two letters

When a spot has two letters — 2 strings split **50:50** ($\frac{1}{2}$), 3 strings split into **$\frac{1}{3}$ • $\frac{2}{3}$** .



2 strings → an even split; 3 strings → a 1:2 split, so two peaks appear.

QUESTION 2 • KEY IDEA

Count how many **strings** are parent A

Using **parent-only markers (diagnostic SNPs)**, count whether A is 0, 1, 2 or 3 of the 3 strings.

0
A × 0



1
A × 1



2
A × 2



3
A × 3



Markers are picked **only from pure parents**, never from the triploid itself. (No copying its own answer.)

We don't trust just one clue

Check whether independent methods reach the same answer.

Chromosome painting

Color A/B tracts along each chromosome (HMM local ancestry).

D-statistic

Weigh which parent's letters are shared more.

k-mer

Cross-check with short letter-chunks, no mapping needed.

COX1

Confirm the maternal line via mitochondria.

Reciprocal mapping

Swap A/B references to check bias.

Diploid baseline

Calibrate against a confirmed 2n control.

Finally · an honest scorecard

Accept only when methods **agree**; if they clash, **show it as is**.

● Supported

Enough independent evidence agrees.

● Needs checking

If calibration fails or evidence is thin, mark **missing**.

● Discordant

If pedigree and COX1 differ, keep it as **discordant**.

This tool does not pin down an exact backcross generation — that needs parent genotypes. Instead it shows **whether the pattern fits a simple cross**.

3NdeTECT — a Snakemake workflow for validating triploidy and hybrid ancestry in animals (oysters). · Figures are simplified for intuition.